

a business? You know, going back to school to get more education for the next level you're trying to get to?" she asked. Unlike my increasingly socialist agenda (LOL), Sokunbi said she sees no point in worrying about anyone but yourself. It's very John Galt of her, and I don't love it, but maybe there's a way to meet in the middle. The system is broken, which is why, she said, you have to be proactive and protect yourself.

In 2017, CNBC reported that 41 percent of people my age had not yet started saving for retirement, mainly because of a lack of disposable income. (I didn't start saving for retirement until I was 29.) In 2017, *Fortune* reported that 70 percent of Gen Xers rely on 401(k)s and the majority of baby boomers rely on Social Security and pensions for retirement. A 2017 Center for Generational Kinetics study showed that 12 percent of Gen Z is already saving for retirement, which is much higher than millennials, who were around their age during the economic downturn in 2008.

Piggy and Kitty from *Bitches Get Riches* said people in their twenties and thirties need to stop looking at retirement as the time when we're no longer relevant to the world. I'll probably still want to write even as I age, just as I was writing stories when I was 6 years old. But like when I was a child, I won't want to have to be writing for money. (Although does anyone want to pay me for my second-grade short story about a soccer summer camp?)

"Retirement" has to be redefined to mean "working without stressing about getting paid or being beholden to needing to pay bills." "When you frame it in those terms, saving for retirement becomes saving for freedom," Kitty said. This change in definition is what motivates those millennials and Gen Z who can actually save.

And it looks like we'll need to. It's debatable whether government benefits like Social Security will exist by the time millennials and Gen Z will be able to use them. One-third of retirement-age Americans rely on the benefits. Some experts insist people my age will be able to access Social Security, and their big argument is, "Well, what other option does the government have other than to keep providing it?" (I don't know, man. Have you ever seen a science-fiction movie?)